SSI Parental Deeming Checklist

How SSA counts YOUR income for your child's SSI — 2026 math

2026 NUMBERS — Use these

$994	$1,491	$497	$20 + $65 ÷2
Individual FBR	Couple FBR	Per other child	Exclusions

When Does Deeming Apply?

- ✓ Child under 18, not married
- ✓ Child lives with you
- ✓ Child not in foster care
- ✓ You have income (not SSI)
- ✓ Stops at age 18

The 6 Steps — Big Picture

Allocation off unearned first, then earned. Then $20 + $65. Then living allowance.

1 **Add parent income**
Unearned + Earned, both parents

2 **Minus $497 per other child**
Off unearned first, then earned

3 **$20 + $65 → ÷2**
$20 off unearned, $65 off earned, remainder ÷2

Your Worksheet

Fill in with your paystubs — big boxes, easy to read

A	Parent 1 unearned (SSDI, interest, child support received)	$_____	
B	Parent 1 earned (wages, self-employment)	$_____	
C	Parent 2 unearned (if 2 parents)	$_____	
D	Parent 2 earned (if 2 parents)	$_____	
E	Other children: ____ × $497 =	$_____	allocation
F	Unearned after allocation (min $0)	$_____	
G	Earned after allocation	$_____	
H	After $20 general exclusion	$_____	
I	After $65 earned + ÷2	$_____	
J	**PARENT COUNTABLE (H + I)**	$_____	KEY
K	**Living allowance: ■ $994 ■ $1,491**	$_____	
L	**DEEMED TO CHILD = J - K (min $0)**	$_____	
M	**CHILD SSI = $994 - L =**	$_____	/mo

Example — Big & Clear

Single parent, $3,000 earned, 0 other kids

$3,000 earned income
Minus $20 general = $2,980
Minus $65 earned = $2,915 ÷ 2 = $1,457.50 countable
Minus $994 living allowance
= $463.50 deemed to child

Child SSI = $994 - $463.50 = $530.50 / month
(If child has $0 own income)

Common Mistakes

- ✕ Forgetting $497 allocation per sibling — it HELPS you
- ✕ Taking $20/$65 off wrong income type
- ✕ Using net pay not gross
- ✕ Missing that IHSS can be excluded
- ✕ Not reporting when other child moves out

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